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The Treatment of Sounds in Language and Literature by Raymond Chapman
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The treatment of sounds in language and literature. By RAYMOND CHAPMAN. Oxford: Blackwell, 1984. Pp. 262.

No reference to R. Jakobson in a book on sounds in literature? But Chapman is not a linguist, much less a phonetician. For example, he states that Spanish *ñ* represents a phonetic sequence [nj] (56)—but since, despite his intended general audience, he freely uses terms like 'allophone', 'suprasegmental', and 'glottal stop' without explanation, why not 'palatal nasal'? Spellings like *maintenang, occasiong* for Midi French, he says, indicate 'nasal vowels' (84); but such spellings indicate precisely a consonantal closure, vis-à-vis the pure nasal vowels of the standard language. French *din-don* is said to differ from Eng. *ding-dong* in 'having nasalization in the vowel' (158)—but the vowels of such Eng. words have relatively heavy anticipatory nasalization. One of C's conclusions is that 'technical knowledge of phonetics and acoustics is not essential for the effective presentation of auditory experience through writing' (229); but surely such knowledge is 'essential' for a critical assessment of the sort that he attempts.

C explores 'the visual representation of auditory experience', and more generally 'the connection between written language and the wider area of things which we hear' (9). He first considers the writer's resources (principally graphic—punctuation, deviant spelling, typography etc.), and then analyses how these features are used to represent a wide range of auditory experience: non-standard dialect, disordered speech, loudness, intonation, various phonation types, non-verbal vocalizations (sighs, grunts, laughter), natural sounds (animal sounds, wind, water etc.), sounds made by inanimate objects, and music. The primary data consist of forty post-Restoration works 'representing the principal literary genres and drawn from a period covering nearly three hundred years' (16–17), with a liberal sprinkling of examples from other texts.

C's choice of data raises certain problems. In general, American English is slighted, barring token references to Mark Twain and a few others. Thus C consciously restricts his chapter on dialect (58–85) to 'some varieties of English spoken within ... the British Isles' (58), and rehearses mostly familiar material from cockney, Scots, and Irish. West Indian, Australian, and Anglo-Indian speech, as well as American dialect literature, go largely untouched. C might better have forgone his gratuitous forays into European (mostly French) literature; by his admission, they merely remind us that 'the difficulties presented by the discrepancy between speech and writing in English ... are not unique' (17)—an obvious fact. To his credit, C attempts to consider the theories of the Russian Futurists; but he depends on a single secondary source. His inability to assess these poets' practice directly makes for a superficial and ultimately unsatisfying account of this highly relevant material.

A recurrent cluster of key issues involves onomatopoeia and sound symbolism. C's positions are refreshingly sound—in particular his cautious approach to universal statements, and his disapproval of the 'subjectivism and fanciful relationships characteristic of some writers and literary movements' (42; but C himself is far from guiltless). However, he seems ignorant of a large body of work on these subjects, from I. Fónagy's classic *Die Metaphern in der Phonetik* (1963) to a number of more recent studies. Thus C's skepticism about size–sound symbolism (219) derives from the limited data in S. Ullman's 1964 *Language and style*; but R. Ultan's 1970 'Size-sound symbolism' (easily accessible in J. Greenberg's 1978 collection *Universals of human language, II: Phonology*), based on data from 136 languages, gives a different impression. The 'dismissive' attitude toward such issues which C repeatedly imputes to modern linguistics is therefore overstated. E. Sapir's important work is unacknowledged; and C has nothing to say about Jakobsonian poetics, much of which bears directly on his discussions of, e.g., the phonetic texture of poetry (220 et passim), poetry vs. prose (212–15), and rhyme (215–17).

The end matter is as frustrating as the text. C's 'Bibliography' (251–7) lists 181 items, but 120 of them cannot be traced in the text through the annoyingly incomplete index (258–62); and of these 120 items, about half never appear in the text at all. Is this, then, a 'list of works consulted'? Glaring omissions abound, and often color the discussions. Thus, for C, phonation types (106 ff.) represent a murky region of phonetics about which little is known; but he cites only J. Catford's 1964 article. Even forgetting subsequent work by C.-W. Kim, P. Ladefoged, and many others, he might at least have men-

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tioned Catford's *Fundamental problems in phonetics* (1976), Ch. 6. [BRENT VINE, *Phillips Academy, Andover, MA.*]

Language and the sexes. By FRANCINE FRANK and FRANK ANSHEN. Albany: State University of New York Press, 1983. Pp. 130. Cloth $24.95, paper $7.95.

This short and very readable book succeeds admirably in its twin goals of presenting important issues from the linguistic literature on language and the sexes to a general audience, and of raising 'linguistic consciousness' about language use and its social implications. Its patient, elementary, and often witty explanations and exemplifications of how language reflects sexism in society make this the perfect book to recommend to friends, students, and even colleagues who persist in maintaining that English usage and language attitudes in our society are not sexist, or who simply want to know 'what all the fuss is about'.

'Naming names' (9–23) shows how naming practices differ for men and women, and how this is linked to the arbitrariness and power of names—as well as to the use of name changes to mark significant events in one's life. 'Talking like a lady: How women talk' (25–50) examines common beliefs and stereotypes about sex differences in language behavior, and the extent to which these traditional notions correspond to reality. 'Hey lady, whose honey are you anyway?' (51–62) is concerned with forms of address (titles, first names, surnames; pronouns; *Ms.*; *honey, dear, boy*). 'Of girls and chicks' (63–77) studies asymmetry in vocabulary and in collocations, in slang and obscene terms, and in the 'generics' *he* and *man*. 'What is to be done' (79–93) deals first with the general issue of language reform, then more specifically with twelve language changes proposed by feminists. The book concludes with some suggested research projects for each chapter, a well-selected bibliography, and a summary 'Guidelines for non-discriminatory language usage'. Throughout the book, an excellent balance is maintained between data drawn from English usage in contemporary American society, or from other languages and societies, and historical examples. Sex differences and sexism in language are also related well to other 'women's' issues (such as women's place in the work force, and non-parity in wages), and excellent parallels are drawn with racism and racist language.

Apart from its usefulness to a general readership, this book could also be an effective text in advanced high-school classes in language arts or family studies; as introductory reading to units on language and sex in Women's Studies or sociolinguistics courses; or as pre-course reading for courses specifically devoted to language and sex. [SHEILA M. EMBLETON, *York University, Toronto.*]

Bilingualism or not: The education of minorities. By TOVE SKUTNABB-KANGAS. (Multilingual matters, 7.) Avon, England: Multilingual Matters, [1984.] Pp. xviii, 378. Cloth £22.80, paper £8.90. [Translation of Tvåspråkighet, 1981.]

SK's book could well be used in a course on 'Language and social issues'. The issue addressed here is the difficulties which minorities and foreign ('guest') workers have in using their own languages and in acquiring the languages of 'host' countries. SK is impassioned about the injustice that characterizes the 'ways in which minorities are prevented from enjoying their fair share of the world's goods' (305), arguing that educational policy fulfills the aims of industrialized nations in exploiting guest workers and immigrants (296). It is in the last chapter ('Violence and minority education') where her thesis is expounded powerfully and convincingly; she claims that physical violence (e.g. corporal punishment in schools) has been largely replaced by structural or symbolic violence or force, as in the use of shame (307, 314).

But the book is not an emotional one—far from it. It reads like a textbook about second-language acquisition by young children, and the chapter titles indicate that this is what SK is really concerned with: 'Something about language', 'What is a mother tongue?', 'Two "languages"', 'What is bilingualism?', 'Different aspects of bilingualism—dichotomies', 'Planning the education of prospective bilinguals', 'How can a child become bilingual with the help of school and family?', 'How is bilingualism measured?', 'Double semilingualism—does it exist?' and 'The function of immigration—a compari-

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